



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Ryan Mohammed

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Thu, Aug 6, 2020 at 12:38 PM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Ryan Mohammed

Gender

Male

Nationality

Trinidadian

Emailryansmohammed2020@gmail.com**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

June, 2019

City, state, and country of residence

Princes Town, Trinidad, Republic of Trinidad and Tobago, West Indies

University education

PhD, Environmental Biology: Aquatic Ecology, The University of the West Indies (UWI), St. Augustine Campus, Trinidad and Tobago. June, 2019.

Project Management Associate, Inter-American Institute for Economic and Social Development, November 2018.

Masters of Philosophy, Environmental Biology: Microbiology and Fish Pathology, UWI, St. Augustine Campus, Trinidad and Tobago. June, 2010.

BSc. Zoology and Botany, UWI, St. Augustine Campus. June, 2003.

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I am applying to the Science Corps Fellowship program as I have an interest in sustainable development and resource management in small island developing states (SIDS). I realised better management means we need to make the younger stakeholders more aware of

environmental and conservation issues as the middle aged and older persons are more difficult to convince particularly if a change in livelihood is one avenue to improve management. It is with this capacity building in youth (5 years to 25 years) communities we will see a positive behavioural change in the way we manage the planet's resources. Knowledge of natural resources and appreciation of biodiversity can all lead to this change. Additionally, I would like work experience outside of the Caribbean in the field of Science education. Whilst I have done teaching during my PhD program in Suriname (South America) and St. Kitts (St. Christopher) and Nevis (Caribbean), this would take me out side of my core Caribbean comfort zone within the Caribbean and help building my capacity as well. Lastly, considering the follow issues of Covid-19 such as food security as several SIDS relied on food importation, I see this as an opportunity introduce youth to sustainable livelihoods.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

I have worked with as a member of the Board of Directors of two Non-governmental Organizations: Environmental Research Institute Charlotteville (ERIC, Corporate Secretary) based in Tobago and the Aquaculture Association of Trinidad and Tobago (aQua-TT, President). For both organizations I have

- 1) conducted both applied and biodiversity research,
- 2) helped build capacity within communities for sustainable development and climate change (with ERIC) and promoting green aquaculture practices implementing proper waste management for aquaculture and processing facilities (with aQua-TT),
- 3) developed policy for environmental and aquaculture issues which are inclusive of community members in keeping with the UN's 17 Sustainable Development Goals and principles of Blue Economy.

Given also that Trinidad and Tobago has two different primary sources of income as Tobago is dependent on fisheries and tourism and Trinidad is more industrial, I had to develop different management of human resources skills as the primary and secondary schools in both countries as well older youth have different financial focus when it comes to environmental issues.

Lastly, I have studied in China and India and seen extremes of poverty among young people. It is hoped that working with Science Corps I can help with alleviating some of these global issues.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
 Doing science in industry
 Administrative role in industry or academia
 In science education
 In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

My short-term goal will be to gain enough work and outreach experience that allows me to have better academic stability to develop long term research projects as I am a firm believer in research-based teaching so this can directly influence policy development and implementation strategies. In the past I have conducting biodiversity baseline studies for industry and developed management plans. Plans such as a recent UNESCO application for North East Tobago as Man and the Bio-sphere and heritage park along with a marine protected area for North East Tobago which have been submitted. Once these plans are approved, I would like to continue my involvement in the implementation of these plans as this is in keeping with our ridge to reef ecosystem management. This could easily go into the 5-year period. As we see Blue Economy principles infiltrating SIDS environmental and financial projections. I hope to continue doing baseline biodiversity assessment and also implementing green aquaculture and fish processing practices. A decade from now I should have enough international experience in policy development, teaching and research to advise the governments' of multiple Caribbean islands on resource management as well as be an established published scientific author.

CV/Resumé

[RYAN-SIMON-MOHAMMED-FULL-CV-6th-Aug-2020.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

A friend or colleague

Any extra comment or message.

I recognize this submission is late and I apologize for this. This is as a direct result of the field course for the MSc. Program where I teach part-time:

Sustainable Use and Development of Natural Resources;

Threats to Tropical Biodiversity;

Taxonomy and Biodiversity Informatics

Ecology Field Practicum.

It is on the Field Practicum we had a potential Covid-19 issue (the student tested negative) which resulted on all staff and students going into isolation at the research station where wifi was not reliable as we also had Tropical Storm Isaias passing over Trinidad and Tobago during that time. I humbly ask that you still consider my application. If considered please also note while I was the Acting Curator of the University of the West Indies Zoology Museum we conducted no less than 10 public displays and outreach sessions to bridge the gap between academics and the public.

Sent from Science Corps